

August 20, 2026

UnitedHealthcare
Provider Appeals
P.O. Box 30432
Salt Lake City, UT 84130

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Pearly Schuster (MRN MUSC8018289), Claim MUSC-A85B-1

Patient	Pearly Schuster (DOB 2016-11-17)
MRN	MUSC8018289
Member ID / Group	UHC395206213 / GRP-93872
Claim number	MUSC-A85B-1
Date of service	2026-02-18
Procedure billed	CPT 99284 — Emergency department visit, moderate-to-high severity
Primary diagnosis	R69 — Illness, unspecified
Denied amount	\$6,942.81
Denial code	CARC 29 / RARC N211 — The time limit for filing has expired.
Appeal deadline	2027-03-24

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Pearly Schuster (MRN: MUSC8018289, Member ID: UHC395206213, Group: GRP-93872) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-A85B-1 for emergency department services rendered on February 18, 2026. UnitedHealthcare denied the claim on March 24, 2026, citing CARC 29 ("The time limit for filing has expired") with the accompanying payer remark that the "claim was received after the contractual filing deadline." RARC N211 was also appended, asserting that the decision may not be appealed. MUSC Health respectfully disputes both the denial and the assertion that appeal rights are unavailable, and requests full reconsideration and payment of the allowed amount.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Pearly Schuster is a nine-year-old female patient who presented to the MUSC Health emergency department on February 18, 2026, and received emergency department services billed under CPT 99284, reflecting a visit of moderate-to-high severity. The claim was submitted on February 25, 2026, seven days following the date of service. The primary diagnosis reported is R69 (Illness, unspecified), with a secondary diagnosis of J06.9. Services were rendered by Amara J. Boone, NP (NPI 1203948576) at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care, Charleston, SC, under place-of-service code 23. The total billed amount was \$6,942.81, against which UnitedHealthcare applied an allowed amount of \$3,976.29 but remitted zero payment.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial on grounds of untimely filing is not supported by the submission record. The date of service was February 18, 2026, and the claim was submitted to UnitedHealthcare on February 25, 2026 — a span of seven calendar days. Under any standard commercial contractual timely filing provision, whether measured in days or months from the date of service, a claim submitted within one week of service cannot reasonably be characterized as filed beyond the contractual deadline. MUSC Health requests that UnitedHealthcare provide the specific contractual filing window it applied and the date on which it contends the filing period expired, so that any discrepancy can be identified and resolved.

Regarding RARC N211, which states that the decision may not be appealed, MUSC Health notes that federal and state regulations governing commercial health plans, as well as UnitedHealthcare's own provider agreement obligations, preserve the right of participating providers to seek reconsideration of adverse claim determinations. A blanket preclusion of appeal rights on a timely-filing denial does not extinguish those rights, and MUSC Health is submitting this appeal within the appeal deadline of March 24, 2027, as stated on the remittance advice. UnitedHealthcare's own portal instructions confirm that electronic reconsideration is available via Claims & Payments, and this appeal is being submitted through that channel accordingly.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that UnitedHealthcare reverse the timely-filing denial, reprocess Claim MUSC-A85B-1 on its merits, and issue payment at the applicable contracted rate. Should UnitedHealthcare require additional documentation — including the original submission confirmation, clearinghouse acceptance report, or medical records supporting the level of service billed — MUSC Health will provide those materials promptly upon request. If UnitedHealthcare maintains that a filing deadline was missed, we request written identification of the specific contractual provision and the date the filing window closed, as this information is necessary to evaluate and respond to the denial basis.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record